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LEO PP. XIII.

Dilecte Fili Noster, Salutem et Apostolicam Benedictionem.

Quos n u p e r coetus Episcopi aliquot H i s p a n i a r u m , te p r a e - s i d e , Matriti c e l e b r a r u n t u t o p p o r t u n i s s i m a a d m o v e n d a m a p u d v o s c a t h o l i c o r u m a c t i o n e m p r a e s i d i a a n i m a d v e r t e r e n t , d e iis N o s c e r t i o r e s efficit d i l e c t u s F i l i u s N o s t e r a p u b l i c i s n e g o t i i s . H a s N o s congressiones libentiore q u a d a m voluntate cognovi- m u s , q u i p p e professi s a e p e n u m e r o p u b l i c e q u e s u m u s nihil N o b i s m a g i s e s s e c u r a e q u a m u t catholici i n H i s p a n i a viri a r - c t i s s i m a i n t e r s e c o n c o r d i a c o h a e r e a n t . Illud e n i m v e r o l a u d a t i coetus perspicue demonstrant Hispanos Praesules non modo de concordiae necessitate Nobiscum consentire, v e r u m etiam ad voluntatum coniunctionem in fidelibus restaurandam omni stu- dio c o n t e n d e r e . Q u o d s a n e c o m p l u r e s E p i s c o p i a d c o n s i l i a c o n - ferenda convenerint, id esse fructus e x p e r s in christiana plebe n o n potest, e o p r a e s e r t i m e x c a p i t e q u o d s u a s c u i q u e o p i n i o - n e s variasque de rebus minime necessariis sententias omnino abiiciendas esse suadeat, si prospicere Religionis rationibus, q u a e m u l t u m i n p r a e s e n s p e r i c l i t a n t u r , c u m efficacitate veli- m u s . Q u a m o b r e m vehementer optamus ut Hispaniae Episcopi constanti stabilique a n i m o insistant d e n u n c i a n p a l a m ac pu- blice s e r v a n d a m c a t h o l i c i s u n i v e r s i s c o n c o r d i a m . S e q u e t u r e n i m s i n e d u b i t a t i o n e u t p a s t o r a l i a p r a e s c r i p t a m a i o r i p o p u l u m vir- t u t e p e r c e l l a n t , a t q u e ea, q u a e a n i m o s p e c t a t i s , l e v i o r e n e g o t i o adipiscamini. Supradictis a u t e m in conventibus p r o l a t u m a qui- b u s d a m consilium c o m p e r i m u s peculiares coetus in q u a q u e

d i o e c e s i c o n d e n d i , q u i c o n s o c i a t i o n i Matriti c o n s t i t u t a e , t a n q u a m capiti, c o n g r u a t . I a m e i u s m o d i sententiam sapienter o p p o r t u n e - que conceptam laude persequi placet: valere n a m q u e posse censemus ad creandum stabiliendumque catholicorum o m n i u m in Hispania c o n s e n s u m . Q u a r e plane confidimus universos istius g e n t i s E p i s c o p o s e i d e m consilio e t o p i n i o n e e t r e fore a d s t i p u - laturos. Huius tamen exequendi negotii, praescriptorumque decernendorum, quibus regendae consociationes erunt, praeci- p u a s p a r t e s d e b e r i tibi v o l u m u s , q u i s u m m u m dignitatis l o c u m in Hispaniae Episcopis obtines. Valde quidem Nobis et agendi s t u d i o , e t r e r u m u s u e t fideli c o n i u n c t i o n e c o m m e n d a r i s : q u o fit ut nullum ad haec incitamentum desideres. Modestiam vero t u a m attollendam impellendamque a r b i t r a m u r , idque libenter p r a e s t a m u s , enixe cohortantes ut m a g n o erectoque animo operi t a m c l a r o p r a e s i s , h o c nihil d u b i t a n s e o s tibi o m n e s a d i u m e n - t u m l a t u r o s q u i d i g n i t a t i s e x s i s t u n t socii. Q u o d s i h u m a n a e conscius infirmitatis divinam r e q u i r e n d a m o p e m a d l a u d a t u m f a c i n u s p u t a s , N o s e t i a m a d s p i r a n t e m p r o p i t i e D e u m tibi d e - p r e c a m u r , a u s p i c e m q u e coelestium g r a t i a r u m Apostolicam Be- n e d i c t i o n e m tibi c o e t e r i s q u e H i s p a n i a r u m E p i s c o p i s a c f i d e l i - bus peramanter impertimur. D a t u m R o m a e a p u d S . P e t r u m die X X I I Aprilis anno MCMIII, P o n t i f i c a t u s N o s t r i v i c e s i m o s e x t o .

LEO P P . XIII.

Dilecto Filio Nostro Cyriaco Mariae Tit. S. Petri in Monte Aureo S. R. E. Presb. Card. Sancha y Hervas Archiepiscopo Toletanorum.

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